

DGP0959 | AI TOOLS FOR WORK AND STUDY

Your AI Toolkit

A practical beginner course for using AI clearly,
critically, and usefully.

Session 01 / 08

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PROTOTYPE

AI tools are useful when the task is clear

The first decision is not the prompt. It is whether the task needs exploration, drafting, comparison, planning, or verification.

EXPLORE

Use AI to understand a topic, list options, or generate questions before research.

DRAFT

Use AI to turn notes into a first version that you can check and improve.

VERIFY

Use reliable sources and human judgement before trusting important claims.

A better prompt gives the AI a job to do

BEFORE

"Write me an email about missing class."

AFTER

"Draft a polite email to my lecturer explaining that I missed today's session due to illness. Ask what I should review before next week. Keep it concise and professional."

Purpose

+

Audience

+

Format

Prompt pattern: summarise without losing decisions

Summarise this document for a student who needs to act on it.

Return:

1. the main point;
2. any dates or deadlines;
3. decisions already made;
4. actions I need to take;
5. claims I should verify.

Prompt slides should remain readable in the PDF, so long prompts are split into clear numbered lines.

Hands-on activity

Turn a messy goal into an action plan

- 1 Choose one real assignment, project, or student task.
- 2 Ask AI to break it into milestones, actions, and risks.
- 3 Revise the plan so every action has a clear next step.
- 4 Mark which parts require human judgement or verification.

Check before pasting

Do not paste private, sensitive, client, patient, student, or unpublished university information into an AI tool unless you know it is allowed.

Remove names, IDs, and contact details.

Use fictional examples when possible.

Ask for structure, not for decisions you must own.

When in doubt, stop and check policy.

Compare outputs before accepting one

Accept first answer

- May miss your audience.
- May hide weak assumptions.
- Often sounds generic.
- Harder to trust later.

Ask for alternatives

- Shows different structures.
- Makes trade-offs visible.
- Lets you combine the best parts.
- Keeps you in control.

What to take away

- 1 Choose the tool by task: explore, draft, compare, plan, present, or verify.
- 2 Good prompts give purpose, context, audience, constraints, and format.
- 3 The final judgement stays with you, especially for private or important work.